

Workplace Equity Survey Dataset: Variable Description

Dataset Overview

N = 150 respondents

Total Variables = 13 (1 ID, 3 demographics, 3 Likert scales, 6 open-ended)

This dataset captures employee perceptions of workplace equity through both quantitative ratings and qualitative narratives. The design allows for reliability analysis, demographic comparison, and thematic coding of lived experiences.

Variable Descriptions

Identifier

- **RespondentID:** Unique identifier (R001–R150)

Demographic Variables

Race (Categorical, 8 levels)

- African American/Black (18%)
- Asian (10%)
- Hispanic/Latino (18%)
- Native American/Indigenous (4%)
- Pacific Islander (2%)
- White (42%)
- Multiracial (5%)
- Prefer not to say (1%)

Distribution reflects U.S. workplace diversity patterns with White as the plurality category.

Gender (Categorical, 5 levels)

- Woman (50%)
- Man (45%)
- Non-binary (3%)
- Prefer to self-describe (1%)
- Prefer not to say (1%)

Near-equal gender split with small representation of non-binary identities.

Role (Categorical, 6 levels - organizational hierarchy)

- Executive/Senior Leadership (7%)
- Director/Department Head (13%)

- Manager (22%)
- Senior Individual Contributor (20%)
- Individual Contributor (28%)
- Entry-Level (10%)

Pyramid structure typical of organizational hierarchies, with most respondents in mid-level roles.

Quantitative Measures (Likert Scale: 1=Strongly Disagree to 5=Strongly Agree)

L1_OrgPromotesEquity

"My organization actively promotes equity and inclusion through its policies and practices."

- Mean: ~3.6 (skews slightly positive overall)
- Systematic variation by demographics: Underrepresented groups rate lower
- Tests organizational climate perception

L2_ContributionsValued

"I feel my contributions are valued equally regardless of my identity or background."

- Mean: ~3.3 (moderate agreement)
- Strongest demographic differences visible here
- Measures personal sense of belonging and recognition

L3_LeadershipCommitment

"Leadership at my organization is genuinely committed to addressing systemic inequities."

- Mean: ~3.1 (lowest of three items)
- Reflects skepticism about institutional follow-through
- Most critical assessment of equity work

Reliability Testing: These three items are designed to form a coherent scale measuring perceptions of organizational equity climate. Expected Cronbach's alpha: 0.75-0.85.

Demographic Patterns in Likert Data:

- African American/Black and Native American/Indigenous respondents: -0.9 points lower on average
- Women: -0.3 points lower
- Non-binary respondents: -0.7 points lower
- Executive/Senior Leadership: +0.6 points higher
- Entry-Level: -0.2 points lower

Qualitative Variables (Open-Ended Text Responses)

Q1_IdentityInfluencedTreatment

"Describe a moment when your identity influenced how you were treated at work."

Response patterns:

- **High marginalization respondents:** Specific incidents (microaggressions, being mistaken for staff, natural hair policing, diversity hire stigma)
- **Moderate marginalization:** Subtle exclusion (interruptions, accommodation challenges, self-editing)
- **Majority group:** Often reports no experience or denies identity as a factor
- ~5% blank/prefer not to answer

Q2_WhatEquityMeans

"What does workplace equity mean to you in practical, day-to-day terms?"

Response patterns:

- **High marginalization:** Structural change, power redistribution, authentic self-expression
- **Moderate marginalization:** Level playing field, transparent processes, recognition of different needs
- **Majority group:** Equal opportunity, merit-based systems, treating everyone the same
- Tests definitional understanding and lived experience of equity

Q3_BarriersToEquity

"What barriers to equity have you observed or experienced in your current workplace?"

Response patterns:

- **High marginalization:** Lack of accountability, opaque promotion decisions, pay inequity, microaggressions going unchallenged
- **Moderate marginalization:** Unconscious bias, slow change, burden on marginalized employees
- **Majority group:** Often report no major barriers or attribute to individual bias rather than systems
- Most actionable data for organizational change

Q4_HowToImprove

"How could your organization improve its approach to equity and inclusion?"

Response patterns:

- **High marginalization:** Concrete structural changes (tie compensation to equity outcomes, pay transparency, fund equity work)
- **Moderate marginalization:** Accountability structures, manager training, retention focus
- **Majority group:** Continue current efforts, more communication
- Tests solution orientation and institutional critique

Q5_IncludedOrExcluded

"Describe a time you felt included or excluded at work, and what shaped that experience."

Response patterns:

- **All groups:** Mix of included/excluded experiences
- **Excluded examples:** Inaccessible venues, informal decision-making networks, social events built around specific activities
- **Included examples:** Manager asking pronunciation, affinity groups, being genuinely heard
- Most emotionally resonant responses

Q6_LeadershipRole

"What role should leadership play in advancing workplace equity?"

Response patterns:

- **High marginalization:** Model behavior, redistribute power, tie metrics to performance, listen to affected people
- **Moderate marginalization:** Create accountability, invest resources, be transparent with data
- **Majority group:** Support current initiatives, lead by example, focus on fairness
- Tests expectations of institutional responsibility

Data Quality Features

Realistic Response Variance: Not all respondents from the same demographic respond identically. Individual variation simulates real survey data.

Missing Data: ~5% of open-ended responses are blank, "N/A," or "Prefer not to answer" to simulate real non-response patterns.

Response Length Variation: Ranges from single words ("No.") to detailed paragraphs, typical of actual survey data.

Internal Consistency: Likert items are correlated but not perfectly, allowing for reliability testing.

Demographic Stratification: Patterns reflect documented research on workplace equity experiences while maintaining individual variation.

Intended Analyses for ReliCheck Testing

1. **Reliability Analysis:** Cronbach's alpha on the 3-item Likert scale
2. **Descriptive Statistics:** Means, standard deviations, distributions by demographic group
3. **Cross-Tabulation:** Likert scores by Race, Gender, and Role
4. **Thematic Coding:** Pattern identification in open-ended responses
5. **Mixed Methods Integration:** Linking quantitative patterns to qualitative themes
6. **Variance Analysis:** Within-group and between-group differences

This dataset provides comprehensive material to test ReliCheck's handling of both quantitative reliability metrics and qualitative pattern detection across identity-based subgroups.